CASE STUDY

The Asiatic Cheetah of India Becomes Extinct

Cheetah is found in Africa and Asia. It is the fastest land animal on Earth. The Asiatic cheetah, is slightly smaller than the African cheetah. It has a fawn-coloured body with black spots and distinctive black "tear marks" running from the corner of each eye down the side of its nose.



The Asiatic cheetah also known as the Iranian cheetah is a **Critically Endangered** subspecies surviving today only in Iran. It was once found in the Arabian Peninsula, Near East, Kyzyl-Kum desert, Caspian region, Pakistan and India. Asiatic cheetahs were once widespread across the continent but were eradicated in India, where they were hunted for sport. The spread of farming also greatly reduced their numbers in the 19th and 20th centuries. Eventually the animal was wiped out in Asia to which it was once native.

Cheetah has been known to exist in India for a very long time. They were kept by Kings and princes, but hunting led to their extinction in the country. In 1948, Maharajah Ramanuj Pratap Singh Deo shot three of the last cheetahs in India, in Surguja, State of Madhya Pradesh which is present day Northern Chhattisgarh.

The Indian government had plans to reintroduce cheetahs back in India in 2009 but this project has not yet been taken up

Biodiversity is necessary for our existence as well as valuable in its own right. This is because it provides the fundamental building blocks for the goods and services that provide us with a healthy environment.Biodiversity includes fundamental things to our health like fresh water clean air and food products, as well as many other products like timber, medicine and fibre.

Biodiversity also includes various other important things and services such as cultural, recreational and spiritual nourishment that play an important role in maintaining our personal life and social life.

It is therefore the duty of every citizen to conserve this valuable life on earth, the most precious gift we can pass on to the future generations.

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